

P1 Hi everyone!

We're Group 1 from Software Engineering.

I'm Mia, and I'll kick off our presentation today.

Our topic is "From Assigned to Designed: The Evolution of Human Identity in the Digital Age."

Let's start with the first part — Introduction: What is identity?

Have you ever asked yourself, "Who am I?"

Identity — or 身份认

同 — is basically all the attributes, beliefs, and experiences that shape how we see ourselves **and** how others see us. It's like a big mix of everything that makes you *you* — your gender, race, family background, culture — all that stuff. In short, it's the very core of *who we are* in every sense.

Alright, so today we've got four parts to explore: **Static Identity, Dynamic Identity, Algorithmic Identity, and the Real Self.**

We'll start from the beginning — Static Identity — and then move step by step.

Part 1: Static Identity

Static Identity is like the "birthmarks" we're born with — things we don't get to choose.

Let's start with **nationality**.

A kid born in the U.S. gets an American passport, which means they can travel to over 180 countries without a visa.

But someone from North Korea? They need a visa almost everywhere.

That's just one example of how your starting point in life can shape your opportunities.

Then there's **family background**.

Imagine being born into the British royal family — you're born into privilege and expectations.

Or being a Walton — part of a business empire.

But if you're a kid in Gaza? Totally different start — limited resources, constant instability.

Ethnicity matters too.

For example, Muslims follow halal rules and don't eat pork.

The Dai people celebrate the Water Splashing Festival.

These cultural roots become part of who we are.

And of course, **biological sex** — male or female — that's something fixed at birth.

Even **time and place of birth** can change everything.

Think about Gaza before and after the war — one side full of life, the other in ruins.

Same place, totally different realities.

So, Static Identity sets our **starting point**, but it doesn't decide our **destination**.

Part 2: Dynamic Identity

Static Identity gives us the foundation, but life's not just about what we're born with. We're constantly reshaping ourselves — that's where **Dynamic Identity** comes in. Ever heard of **Dissociative Identity Disorder (DID)**? Like in the book *24 Faces* — the author shares his real-life story of having 24 different personalities.

Or in the Chinese drama *Seven of Me*, the main character has seven totally distinct selves.

These extreme examples show how fluid identity can be — if someone can have multiple selves, imagine how much *we all* shift and grow over time!

So Dynamic Identity is basically the “**performed self**” — the version of us that keeps evolving.

Let's talk about what drives that change.

First, **self-cognition iteration** — meaning our identity grows as we experience and reflect on life.

Tara Westover from the book *Educated*.

She grew up isolated, with no formal schooling, in a super strict family.

But she pushed herself to learn, got into university, and completely transformed her life.

That's how reflection and experience reshape our sense of self — from a confused child to an accomplished scholar.

Second, there's **self-actualization** — the need to become our best possible selves.

Maslow's hierarchy of needs tells us that deep down, we all strive to realize our potential.

So we keep adjusting our identity to close the gap between our *real self* and our *ideal self*.

It's like the Chinese saying “**人定胜天**” — we don't just accept what life gives us; we create who we want to be.

Now, let's bring in the digital side of Dynamic Identity.

Ever wonder why people have **Weibo 小号** — secret accounts?

Because in real life, we can't always be our full selves.

At work, we have to stay professional; with family, we stay polite.

But inside, we've got emotions, frustrations, and weird hobbies we can't always show.

That's where the 小号 comes in — it's our “hidden me.”

We can rant, share unfiltered thoughts, or just be *real* without judgment.

And think about how different apps bring out different sides of us:

On **DingTalk**, we're serious and formal.

On **WeChat** or **QQ空间**, we're relaxed and funny.

On **TikTok**, we're playful, maybe even a little crazy.

And on a private **Weibo**, we might get vulnerable, sharing our true feelings.

Each platform gives us space to express a different version of “me.”

That's what makes identity *dynamic* in today's digital world — we're constantly switching, adapting, and expressing different sides of ourselves depending on where we are.

Part 3: Identity

To follow up on what my teammate said—that identity is dynamic—I'd like to talk about how recommendation algorithms affect our dynamic identity across different platforms.